

Jennifer Thornton

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SUMMARY

Senior Fraud & Compliance Operations Analyst with 7+ years of experience building and scaling risk detection capabilities within hyper-growth fintech ecosystems. Expert investigator skilled in leveraging ML-driven fraud models, AI agents, and advanced data analytics to automate operational workflows and accelerate response times. Adept at managing complex financial abuse cases, delivering defensible regulatory reporting, and cross-functionally partnering with Legal, Product, and Engineering. Currently working towards CAMS certification — expected completion September 2026.

AT A GLANCE

CURRENT ROLE Sr. Risk Operations Analyst	EMPLOYER Benevity, Inc.	CERTIFICATION IN PROGRESS CAMS (exp. Sept 2026)
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CORE SKILLS

Fraud Detection & Investigation End-to-end case management from alert triage through resolution. Non-profit fraud, collusion schemes, account takeover, impersonation, and financial abuse at scale.	AML & Regulatory Compliance STR playbook development, FINTRAC reporting, KYC/EDD vetting, sanctions and PEP screening, and adverse media monitoring.
AI & Automation Built an AI investigation agent reducing manual effort by 48% via forensic analysis and OSINT with human-in-the-loop verification. ML model validation and anomaly detection.	Risk Strategy & Operations Detection rule design, KPI frameworks, process gap identification, and senior leadership recommendations that translate risk signals into clear action.
Cross-functional Partnership Proven track record with Legal, Product, Engineering, Security, and PR. Senior escalation point on complex, high-visibility incidents.	Team Leadership & Development Former manager of a 7-person compliance team — coaching, QA processes, and sustainable operational workflows.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

SQL	BigQuery	Jira	Confluence	Zendesk	Figma	GitHub	GSuite	Google Sheets	Microsoft Excel
Slack	Claude	ChatGPT	Gemini	NotebookLM	Sumsub	Inscribe.ai	Google Cybersecurity Certificate		

EXPERIENCE

JAN 2026 – PRESENT
Benevity, Inc.

Senior Risk Operations Analyst

- Founding Senior Fraud Operations Analyst responsible for building and scaling fraud detection and monitoring capabilities within Benevity's platform.
- Established monthly fraud metrics and KPIs to highlight program impact and monitor progress for senior leadership.
- Successfully recovered over \$315,000 in funds through fraud investigations within the first month of implementing new standardized processes (April 2026).
- Lead complex investigations into non-profit fraud, collusion schemes, impersonation, and account takeover activity, ensuring protection of corporate client giving programs.
- Developed a comprehensive investigation framework and "front-door" JIRA escalation path, ensuring consistent, defensible, and scalable case management.
- Created an AI investigation agent to reduce manual investigation efforts by 48%. Agent performs forensic donation analysis and OSINT with human-in-the-loop verification.
- Implemented a company-wide communication strategy and reusable templates to ensure consistent, secure language that maintains the integrity of the fraud program.
- Communicate directly with enterprise clients (Top 20 global organizations), providing investigation updates, risk insights, and timely resolution of high-impact fraud incidents.
- Built Benevity's Suspicious Transaction Reporting (STR) playbook and end-to-end process, supporting ongoing cross-border compliance frameworks (FINTRAC) and regulatory reporting obligations.
- Partnered with Engineering to build an ML-driven fraud model by validating data, providing historical investigation insights, and developing tripwires and anomaly detectors.
- Identified gaps in non-profit KYC/EDD vetting; utilized adverse media and sanctions monitoring to mitigate risk. Created AI OSINT prompts for sanctions, PEP, and adverse media checks.
- Identified critical gaps in adverse media monitoring and manual transaction processes, delivering recommendations to leadership and partnering with vendors to implement automation.

JUL 2023 – DEC 2025
Shopify

Senior Policy & Compliance Analyst, Partner Governance

- Senior point of contact for complex partner program violations including fraud and abuse, security vulnerabilities, and general non-compliance.
- Designed and implemented process workflows for policy violations with a focus on identifying areas for automation, improving efficiency, and reducing operational toil.
- Point of contact for incidents involving Shopify Partners, working with stakeholders across legal, marketing, security, and product.
- Provided risk assessments for product teams, combining historical policy knowledge and research to identify risks and deliver recommendations.
- Monitored partner activity to identify fraud trends and collaborated with Shopify's merchant fraud team to share findings and mitigate risk.
- Identified areas of opportunity to implement AI solutions to improve day-to-day efficiency.

JAN 2022 – JUL 2023
Shopify

Compliance Manager, Partner Governance

- Managed a team of 7 Compliance Specialists, coaching them into subject-matter experts through targeted development and support.
- Introduced segmented work streams — Security & Fraud, General Compliance, Partnership Terminations — to enhance SLAs and streamline operations.
- Implemented a QA process for ticket-based work to ensure consistency and identify coaching opportunities for team career growth.
- Served as senior escalation point for critical incidents, collaborating with Legal, PR, and Senior Leadership to resolve complex issues.
- Developed standardized email templates for each partner program violation with an emphasis on providing educational opportunities and enforcing compliance.

OCT 2020 – JAN 2022
Shopify

Strategic Specialist, Partner Governance

- Consistently maintained a high volume of ticket-based work through Zendesk, prioritizing high-risk and urgent cases to protect the ecosystem and ensure merchant safety.
- Created and optimized workflows in a rapidly growing department, balancing partner community growth while minimizing risks.
- Worked closely with senior stakeholders across security, PR, legal, and leadership to address and resolve complex issues.
- Participated in the on-call schedule, providing timely communications during critical incidents.

JUL 2017 – OCT 2020
Shopify

Financial Services Specialist

- Managed a high-volume ticket queue covering billing inquiries, chargeback monitoring, refund abuse, and Shopify Payments troubleshooting.
- Founding member of the 1099-K support team, processing corrections and filing 1099-K reporting for eligible U.S. merchants.
- Led the Canada West billing and payments team for one year, overseeing 12 specialists with a focus on performance coaching and QA.

NOV 2016 – JUL 2017
Shopify

Support Advisor

- Front-line merchant support, building foundational knowledge of the Shopify platform and payments ecosystem.